

**Medford School Committee
Medford, Massachusetts**

**Committee of the Whole
October 25, 2012
Minutes**

The meeting was called to order by Vice-Chairperson John Falco at 7:00 p.m. in the Superintendent's Conference Room at Medford High School. The following members were in attendance: Chairperson Falco, Secretary Paulette Van der Kloot, Erin DiBenedetto, George Scarpelli, and Robert Emmett Skerry Jr. Also in attendance: Superintendent Roy Belson, Director of Administration and Finance Ann Giombetti, Food Service Director Juile Bradley, Food Service Secretary Maria Arcieri, and Nutrition Consultant Dominica Nichols.

All rose to salute the Flag.

Superintendent Belson stated that the purpose of the meeting was to get an update on the current program and to learn of new requirements and initiatives. The Food Service Program is intended to be both nutritional and educational.

Food Service Director Juile Bradley with the assistance of Department Clerk Maria Arcieri and Nutrition Consultant Dominica Nichols presented their report. (see attachment) Specifics included the following:

- Current participation is at 35.7% with an expectation to reach closer to 40% free and reduced.
- Collection of forms for eligibility progress into November. Efforts are made to reach out to families that do not speak English as a first language. (see charts of school participation)
- Food Service Department must verify 3% of all applications
- Medford is ahead of most districts with nutrition menu planning. There are limits on certain foods. For example: pizza cannot be served 5 days per week (Wed off). Muffins cannot exceed 2 grams of grain. Massachusetts has higher standards than the Federal Government.
- More fresh fruits and vegetables are being served than ever before. We are using more New England agriculture products.
- Medford has acquired several grants to improve the quality of our offerings.
- Our breakfast program is expanding.

- Program waiting to hear if we will receive additional funding under the Federal Healthier Schools Challenge Program.
- Food Service Advisory Council is meeting monthly.
- Samples of current food service offerings were displayed.

Committee members asked multiple questions of the Food Service staff.

Director of Finance and Administration Ann Giombetti provided the Committee with a financial status report on the program. (see attached.)

The POS system is working and the second wave of implementation will occur after January 2013.

The Wellness Plan will have to be updated this year to meet new guidelines.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Scarpelli the meeting was adjourned at 8:47 p.m.

Respectfully Submitted,

John Falco
Vice Chairperson